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hedwigedu.com/practice/SpeakingIt/?num=1

0:00

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Talk about a virtual art gallery.

- What are some of the advantages of a virtual art gallery?
- Who might be interested in visiting a virtual art gallery?
- Would you rather visit a virtual gallery or a real one?

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Re-practice Submit

Answer

First of all, virtual art galleries can enrich students' learning. Students can visually see what they have learned and got a more accurate idea of an abstract concept. It can also offer savings in terms of reasonable costs because students can save time, money, and effort required when visiting physical exhibitions. Therefore, it is convenient for students to take a tour through the internet to a virtual art gallery. It would also be interesting to have such experience as it is so different from the real art gallery. As I have never experienced it before, I would try visiting the virtual gallery first and then decide whether it is better than a real one.

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hedwigedu.com/practice/Speakinglr/?num=2

1:24

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Discuss something you were thankful for recently.

- Why were you thankful?
- How did you show that you were thankful?
- Did you thank someone?
- If so, who?

Record

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Re-practice Submit

Answer

I want to describe something that I'm thankful for recently, which is the internet. When I was really young, and I wanted to learn about something, then I had to ask someone who may have had spotty knowledge. Or I had to visit the local library and maybe there was a book or magazine about it. Things are so different now, and even though it is just a part of everyday life, it is still amazing. I can learn about pretty much anything online. I can add new skills and habits to make my life happier and more impressive with the help of what other people share online. Plus, there is the opportunity to connect with and get to know people from all around the world. It is easy to get caught up in the busyness of life. We often take things for granted and fail to notice and appreciate the abundance, and there is always something to be thankful for in our lives. Therefore, we need to appreciate the things around us, and my way to show thankfulness is to say "thank you" all the time.

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#3 Speaking Interview Read

1:22

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Describe how cities assist disabled citizens.

- What kinds of things can they do?
- What does your city do to assist disabled people?

Record

Re-practice Submit

Answer

Most cities are utterly unfriendly to people with disabilities. It is the government's responsibility to help disabled people to have a more comfortable life. There are many things that cities can do to support them. For example, put ramps on public transportation and make assisted-use toilets more available. Governments should also encourage social inclusion and help the public to show more respect for people with disabilities. In the city where I am living, the government did a lot to help them. The most effective one is to provide special financial support and job opportunities for disabled people. As a result, disabled people are more likely to have a stable job and live a more comfortable life.

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1:24

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Talk about something that gets you excited.

- What is it?
- What about it gets you so excited?
- How often does this happen?

Record

Re-practice Submit

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Re-practice Submit

Answer

To be honest, there aren't many exciting things going on in my life at the moment, but if I have to talk about one, I would say the weekly coffee date with my best friend is what excites me the most. I look forward to this date so much because my friend and I rarely have a chance to talk on weekdays. Back in school, the two of us were like the white on rice; I mean, we were inseparable. I could spend days and nights gossiping with my best friend, and meeting each other was never a problem for us. However, since graduation, both of us are always buried in work, so it gets harder to stay in contact regularly. So now, weekends are the only time we can meet up, and the thought of it never fails to excite me. There are millions of things that I and my bestie can do together. Most of the time, we choose a lovely cafe to sit down and have a chat. On some other occasions, we go shopping or have brunch in a fancy restaurant. What we do doesn't matter, as long as we can see each other. I feel relieved every time I confide in my best friend because I know she will always cheer me up and give me some useful advice. All in all, this is one of the things that excites me the most. Thank you for listening.

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1:27

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Discuss the use of traditional medicine and modern medicine in your country.

- What are some examples of traditional medicine?
- Is the use of traditional medicine increasing, decreasing, or remaining the same?
- What is your opinion of traditional medicine?

Record

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Re-practice Submit

Answer

Traditional Chinese medicine is designed to help patients achieve and maintain health. Examples of traditional medicine are Chinese herbs and animal products. Due to the development of modern technology, the use of traditional medicine has been decreasing. Most people believe that modern medicine is more effective than traditional medicine. As far as I am concerned, traditional medicine is beneficial to our health in the longer-term. Besides, traditional medicine is an essential part of our culture and history; we should protect it from disappearing

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#6 Speaking Interview Read

1:25

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Discuss how a person can gain credibility.

- Who is someone who has credibility in your eyes?
- How can a person gain credibility?
- Why is credibility important to an individual or company?

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- Why is credibility important to an individual or company?

Record

Re-practice Submit

Answer

I think anyone who has credibility must be those who are trustworthy and always keep a promise. There are many ways to gain credibility, such as be accountable and honest. To establish credibility, you must be responsible for your decisions and actions. Credibility is, in a way, more important than success. It means others look at you as a reliable resource and decision-maker. It allows those who rely on you to know they can count on you, trust you, do business with you, and align with you

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#7 Speaking Interview Read

1:26

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Describe a foreign culture that you like.

- What culture is it?
- When were you first exposed to this culture?
- How does that culture compare to your own?

Record

Record

Re-practice Submit

Answer

I know of many foreign cultures such as the fast food culture and the call-centre job culture. But here I would like to talk about a foreign culture which I really like. This is the celebration of a special day which is Mother's Day. My cousin came from US last year and she told me about this day. It is falls on the second Sunday of May every year. This day is celebrated with a lot of happiness and enthusiasm. I feel that this culture is interesting because it gives children an opportunity to thank their mothers for all the sacrifices she does in raising them. In our country, we don't pay enough attention to Mothers'day.

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1:20

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Describe people who thrive on hard work.

- Why is hard work so important for some people?
- Is this a healthy attitude?
- Why or why not?

Record

Re-practice Submit

Record

Re-practice Submit

Answer

The reasons why hard work is so important for some people are various. Personally, the sense of achievement is the first and foremost reason for hardworking. There is no shortcut to success, and hard work is the only key to achieving it. Through hard work, we can learn discipline, dedication, and determination, which are all valuable characteristics that one should pursue in their entire lives. And only by doing so, one can demonstrate that others can trust him or her. That is to say, talk the talk, walk the walk. What's more, one can find happiness and joy in hard work. There is no doubt that those who feel the most fulfilled at the end of their lives are those who have chosen to work hard. Besides, people can gain practical experience by working hard, which is an essential component of better performance.

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1:26

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Talk about a goal or ambition you have.

- What is it?
- How long have you had this goal?
- How difficult will it be to fulfill it?

Record

Re-practice Submit

Answer

Different people have different types of short term goals. Some want to save up some money to buy a luxury car while others want to travel to a few countries. Well, I also have a short term goal, and that is to set up a workout routine for doing some daily physical exercise. Well, I have been carrying this thought inside my head that I would need to work on my physical fitness for almost a year, but I haven't managed to do it yet either because I have been too lazy or have been too busy. But, time has certainly become a bit more serious about my health and fitness, mainly because I am spending plenty of time at my office, which makes me gain weight. After all, sitting on a chair for a significant part of the way without any physical activity, in the long run, is a recipe for disaster as far as your health is concerned, especially if you do not strictly control your diet. Besides, my age is also not on my side because the older I become, the more difficult it will get to get rid of the extra weight I gain. At least, my doctor thinks so when he suggests getting rid of my extra weight. Anyway, I know that setting up this workout routine is not going to be easy because I am not exactly a very organized person. Besides, the responsibilities and the current work schedules I have at my job won't exactly allow me to set a fixed workout routine unless I become more aggressive and innovative about it. In order to set up this workout routine, first, I need to cut my nap time as well as my regular sleep time, if possible. Then I would also need to reduce the time that I sometimes use for socializing purposes with my friends. Besides, I would also need to be more efficient at my work so that I don't have to spend too much time on a specific task or assignment.

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1:28

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Discuss the causes and effects of a company relocating.

- Why might a company relocate?
- What can happen to the company's business?
- What can happen to the company's employees?

Record

Re-practice Submit

Answer

A company may relocate itself when it has to control its cost. If relocating the company can reduce the cost of rent, especially when the company is facing a crisis in managing its financial status, it will be most likely to relocate. Another reason might be that the company will increase its profits when relocating to the center of its target market. For example, a company may find its customer base mainly in a certain district of the city. Then relocating to this area is likely to increase its sales. A change in location can also lead to an opportunity that doesn't currently exist for the business. However, from the perspective of employees, they are more likely to travel a long distance to commute, so they may find it difficult to maintain a daily routine. It will cause certain problems among employees but working from home is a good option when managers are experienced in managing such a form of working. Another option would be recruiting new employees from the local area. Still, it will cost too much, and other problems will arise, say that new employees will take time to familiarize themselves and adapt to the company.

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1:25

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Talk about the most difficult aspects of learning.

- Which is more difficult: grammar or pronunciation?
- What is one aspect of English that is very different from your native language?
- What resources were most helpful to you?

Record

Navigation

Answer

While learning English, it is pretty difficult to learn grammar rather than pronunciation because English grammar is very different from Chinese, which is my native language. It is not like Spanish and Italian or other European languages that are more similar to each other. Some may say English pronunciation is also very different from Chinese pronunciation, but I believe that listening and imitating how native English speakers say it can be helpful, and you don't have to sound exactly like a native speaker. Once my pronunciation does not hinder communication, I think I will be fine. As a result, learning grammar requires more attention to details, especially when dealing with academic writing. For example, in Chinese, we put every adjective in front of a noun to describe it, while in English, adjectives can be a relative clause or other grammatical structures that can be put behind a noun. Therefore, it is very challenging when our first language interferes with the use of the second language. The most helpful resources would be a large amount of reading followed up by summarizing the reading and paraphrasing. Reading helps to make sure that I am exposed to all kinds of vocabulary and grammar regularly and give me content knowledge, which I do not have to come up with when writing. This gives me a chance to focus more carefully on my language performance rather than struggling with what idea or content that I am going to present. Later on, teachers may correct my mistakes or errors in my summary and paraphrasing, which could help me understand the grammar. I believe this is the best way for me to improve my grammar.

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#12 Speaking Interview Read

1:23

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Describe a historical place that you know about.

- What is it called?
- Where is it located?
- What is the historical significance of the place?

Record

Re-practice Submit

Answer

I love to visit popular places whenever I'm free, and historic places have special appeals to me. I have visited a few historic places including Machu Picchu in Peru, The Pyramids at Giza, Taj Mahal in India, and the Parthenon in Greece. The historic significance and the grandeur of these places mesmerize me. The place that I would like to talk about today is Colosseum (also known as Coliseum, or as the Flavian Amphitheatre) which is situated in Rome, Italy. I would like to thank you for the time you have allowed me to talk about it. It is basically an elliptical amphitheater in the center of the city of Rome, which is the largest amphitheater in the world and is made of concrete and stone. The construction of Colosseum began under emperor Vespasian in 70 AD and was completed under Titus in 80 AD. The Colosseum could hold approximately 50,000 to 80,000 spectators at the time when it was used as an amphitheater. Perhaps it is well-known for its use for the gladiatorial contests and public spectacles, such as mock sea battles, animal hunts, executions, re-enactments of many famous battles. The Colosseum was listed as a World Heritage Site by UNESCO in 1980 and was also included among the New Seven Wonders of the World. It is 189 meters long, and 156 meters wide, with a base area of 6 acres. The height of the outer wall is 48 meters. The Colosseum nowadays is one of the major tourist attractions in Rome with thousands of tourists each year paying to view the interior arena. I have heard and seen of this famous place a lot and when I witnessed it for the first time, I became speechless. The huge architect, the overwhelming interior and exterior decoration were beyond appreciation. The place kept reminding me of the classical mythological and historical facts I have read and heard about. Visiting this site was like travelling to the past. I would always like to get back to this place due to its prominence in history and incredible appeal.

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#13 Speaking Interview Read

1:26

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Talk about a popular song in your country.

- What is the name of the song?
- Who sings it?
- Do you like the song?

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Re-practice Submit

Answer

When it comes to a popular song in my country, I would say it will be "Tian Mi Mi" (Sweet Honey). It is a 1979 Mandarin Chinese Song by Teresa Deng, who was widely regarded as one of the most famous singers in China and was regarded as having one of the most beautiful voices in the history of Chinese music. In China, Teresa was among the earliest singers people got to know after the reform and opening-up. I like the song very much because it reminds me of the happy time when I listened to this song with my mom in my childhood. That was the happiest time of my life. We both like this song because of Teresa's sweet voice and its beautiful melody.

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#14 Speaking Interview Read

1:27

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Discuss a speech or lecture that you heard.

- Who gave the speech?
- What was the topic of the speech?
- Were you impressed? Why or why not?

Record

Record

Re-practice Submit

Answer

OK, I'm going to talk about a speech I heard on TED that was giving by a famous lecturer, and the topic was about the global environmental issues. Before I heard this lecture, I used to think that lectures were all about telling jokes to make the audience laugh. But after I watched one of the TED performances on a TV program about one year ago, it really blew my mind. I never thought that a lecture could change boring subjects, such as social and political issues, into a thoughtful and creative show. It was this TED show that completely changed my perspective about lectures. I think this is what made this lecture stand out among all the TV programs. It has the ability to talk about very serious and controversial issues in a way that can connect with normal people. Therefore, I was super impressed by the TED lecture.

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#15 Speaking Interview Read

1:25

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Describe a time in your life when you were very busy.

- When was this?
- What all were you doing?
- How did you manage your time?

Record

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Re-practice Submit

Answer

It was the last couple of weeks of the semester in 2016, and I was in the final year of my bachelor's degree. During this period, I was rather busy as I had to complete my final year project while getting ready for final year exam simultaneously. On the very first day I realized that I had to make a proper timetable for both works. Otherwise it would be highly likely that I lose either final year project or exam, which both were equally important for completing my degree. Though I spent few hours to make that plan it was really helpful for me to manage both task without getting too much stress. Even though I had a plan and timetable for my works, I had to work 15-18 hours per day with few hours' sleep. Some days I felt that I was going to suffer from shock or even die of tiredness. But after having a short interval of break - a hot shower usually served the purpose - I was able to reduce my stress down to certain level, and eventually I went through those bleakest time throughout the course.

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#16 Speaking Interview Read

1:25

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Discuss why people borrow money.

- In what situations do people borrow money?
- Who can they borrow from?
- What are the risks associated with borrowing money?

Record

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Re-practice Submit

Answer

Different people have different notions of debt and borrowing. While someone might consider it okay to borrow money for all things big and small, others might be strictly against the borrowing of any sort. However, certain situations in life leave no option but to borrow money. One of the most prevailing ways to borrow money is to take a loan, primarily from a financial institute such as a bank, but you must repay the original amount plus interests within a pre-agreed time. This is usually done by signing a contract. Such debt, when used correctly, can help you in many ways. However, if misused, a loan could also get you trapped in a vicious debt cycle that can be hazardous for your financial health. That is to say, if you, for any reason, cannot pay off the debt in time, then the lender can, by law, take your current assets that is equal to the value of your debt as pledge until the full repayment is made. Thus, it is important to remember that some debt is good as it helps you in your economic growth and also to save money, but the wrong kind of debt can be debilitating and cause a lot of harm to your financial plans. People sometimes choose to borrow from their relatives or friends as this kind of borrowing probably involves no or very little interest. However, in the cases where the borrower cannot pay off the debt, the relationship between the 2 parties may be harmed. Therefore, before you borrow an amount, ask yourself if the expense is justified and whether you are in a position to repay it on time. As long as you are clear about your short-term and long-term financial situation, there is no harm in borrowing money.

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1:27

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Discuss whether vaccinations should be required for children.

- What are the benefits of vaccinations?
- What are the risks if children are not vaccinated?
- Why might people not vaccinate their children?

Record

Re-practice Submit

Answer

In my opinion, vaccinations are critically important for children to take due to the fact that they have not yet fully developed an immune system strong enough to protect themselves from various infections. The necessity of vaccinations has been recognized worldwide for a long time, and thus vaccinations are now compulsory for children to take in an increasing number of countries. Children are required to receive a series of vaccinations since they are born, and the entire course can take up to several years as some of them consist of multiple stages, and a period of interval, ranging from one week to several months, is required in between each of the 2 stages. The vaccinations can prevent children from being infected by a broad range of diseases during their early age where such diseases can potentially result in serious illness, and do harm to their health or even fatality. If, due to any reason, a child is not vaccinated against a certain disease, it is highly likely that the child's health can be permanently impaired, or, worst of all, the child's life can be cruelly taken by that particular disease. Either way, it will consequently lead to tragic grief which nobody would like to experience. Nonetheless, there certainly are a number of children in the world, who are not so lucky to be able to receive vaccinations. The reason is primarily poverty. Either the children's family are too poor to afford the vaccinations, or the countries they live in do not have the healthcare system to provide the vaccinations.

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1:27

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Describe some luxury goods in your culture.

- Which luxuries are the most highly desired in your country?
- Who enjoys these luxuries?
- If you were rich, what luxury goods would you buy?

Record

Re-practice Submit

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Re-practice Submit

Answer

When it comes to the most highly desired luxuries in my country, I suppose they are the luxurious cars and the luxury goods of well-known brands, such as Chanel, Gucci, Louis Vuitton etc. Among all the luxury car brands, people in my country love Bentley and Rolls Royce the most. However, those tier 1 luxury brands are not affordable to the majority of the people, and thus Mercedes-Benz, BMW and Audi are the best sellers. Those 3 brands together are often referred to as BBA, and whoever drives a car of those brands is usually deemed to be rich and successful, even if the car he or she is driving is actually the cheapest among all the products of the luxury brands. In terms of the luxury goods other than cars, people in my country have a strong affection for luxury brands from western countries, for example, Burberry from the United Kingdom, YSL, Givenchy, Chanel and LV from France. They have a particular interest in the leather goods of those big brands, such as leather bags leather belts and leather shoes. The reason for that is probably leather is relatively rare in nature, requires rather fine craft, and thus could only be afforded by rich and noble people in the past. For centuries, luxury goods have been seen as the representation of wealth, good taste and even high social position. As a result, people in my country, especially those aged from 18 to 50s, very much enjoy those luxuries. Possessing and using luxury goods seem to enhance people's confidence. If I were rich, I probably would buy a super cool car first as I have always wanted to drive my dream car with my besties sitting in the car, hanging out and chilling.

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1:26

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Describe someone you know who has a lot of responsibilities.

- What is this person's relationship to you?
- What kinds of responsibilities do they have?

Record

Re-practice Submit

Record

Re-practice Submit

Answer

When it comes to a person I know who has a lot of responsibilities, I suppose that would be my father. To me, he is a hero, an ideal father, a benevolent person and a man of his honour. He is in his 50s now. My father assumes the responsibility of being both a qualified husband, father of 2 children and the head and primary support of our family. Though he can't manage every aspect of our family due to his age, yet he is still the decision maker of our family, and each single decision he has ever made involves a high level of sophistication and great kindness towards every other person. I remember him from my early childhood when he used to play chess with me. He taught me many things including the value of responsibility, honesty and punctuality. He told me some of his great adventures in his life through stories and those stories are still inspiring for me. He is a person of his word. He would not talk much but when he does it carries unparallel weights. He is a benevolent person as I have seen him helping many people in our locality. We never take his love and care for granted, instead, we very much appreciate all the things he has done for us. I revere my grandfather for his acute observation and great decisions. I love him and admire him so much that I want to become a person like him.

Re-practice Submit

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1:26

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Describe some ways to deal with depression.

- What activities might help someone overcome depression?
- What advice would you give to someone who feels depressed?
- Why might it be difficult to overcome depression?

Record

Re-practice Submit

Answer

Depression drains your energy, hope, and drive, making it difficult to take the steps that will help you to feel better. Sometimes, just thinking about the things you should do to feel better, like exercising or spending time with friends, can seem exhausting or impossible to put into action. In order to overcome depression, you have to do things that relax and energize you. This includes following a healthy lifestyle, learning how to manage stress better, setting limits on what you're able to do, and scheduling fun activities into your day. Getting support from others plays an essential role in overcoming depression. On your own, it can be challenging to maintain a healthy perspective and sustain the effort required to beat depression. At the same time, the very nature of depression makes it difficult to reach out for help. When you're depressed, the tendency is to withdraw and isolate so that connecting to even close family members and friends can be tough.

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#21 Speaking Interview Read

1:27

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Describe an important letter that you received.

- Who wrote it to you?
- What was the letter about?
- How did it make you feel?

Record

Re-practice Submit

Answer

Though people mostly send emails nowadays for official and personal communication, the handwritten letter has its own importance as well. Today I would like to talk about a handwritten letter that I received when I was 14 years old. This particular letter was written by my father and I was so excited to receive it that I read it several times. The letter was about the scholarship result and my father wrote to me to inform me that I got the scholarship. In his letter, he congratulated me and wrote that he was proud of me. I was staying at my uncle's place after the final and scholarship exam with my mother and brother. One day I found that a postman delivered a letter to my uncle. My uncle handed over me the letter as it was addressed to me. I found that it was written by my father. I read the letter quickly and was very excited to learn the news. I read it again and then informed my mother and relatives about it. My mother read it and congratulated me as well. As I was only 14 by then, the scholarship was very desiring for me. I could tell how delightful my father was by reading the letter, that made me even happier.

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1:26

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Describe some examples of tedious jobs or tasks.

- What makes these jobs tedious?
- How can people try to overcome the tedium?
- If it were possible, would you use robots to perform some of these jobs?

Record

Re-practice Submit

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Answer

Throughout the year, a teacher is expected to teach the same things every day. Teachers often follow a syllabus, making this experience less creative and involving. The teacher also has the daunting task of assessing the children's understanding through tests. Doing this, every year leaves you bored. Teachers need a lot of motivation to stay focused on the goal. Teaching helps teacher get a sense of fulfillment, particularly when a student perform well academically. Cleanliness is good, but having a job as a housekeeper or a cleaner can be one of the most frustrating jobs in the world. Using the same cleaning equipment, cleaning the same place every single day may not be one of the best experiences in the world. They can put headphones on and play their favourite music when doing the cleaning to overcome the tedium. Feeding data into the computer sounds easy and enjoyable until the figures and numbers start looking similar and confusing. The work is brain draining and a tedious rigmarole. It provides little room for creativity and offers few thrills. The mind naturally loses interest in doing systematic tasks. The only thing that could probably keep a person interested in the job is the fact that it has a good pay check. If it was possible, I would like to have the housekeeping and data entry replaced by robots as these two jobs are essentially manual-based, and hardly require any interaction with other people.

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#23 Speaking Interview Read

1:25

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Talk about something that annoys you.

- Why does it annoy you?
- How do you react when someone does this?
- Do you think this annoys others as well?

Record

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Answer

Every single person on this planet face good and bad experiences daily, but sometimes we have to deal with people who are just far too annoying. I know just a person in my life who annoys all the time. He is my flatmate. He never leaves me alone. He knocks on my door at least once every day. And sometimes multiple times a day. Either way, it is too much. Sometimes he comes to me to borrow money, to borrow my screwdriver and sometimes to borrow my laptop. He borrows money, then pays me back but then borrow again. Over and over again I am always so nice to him because we live in the same apartment. But the problem is that if I gave him everything every time, he would get into the habit of making a straight line towards my door before he even tries any other avenues, such as asking another friend or family member for help. Nonetheless, his behaviour with other people is quite different. Never does he irritate other people so much. And I know why he is doing so with me because I never say no. But to overcome this situation, I need to tell him that his problems are not my problems and that he has to be able to take care of himself. When he again asks for any help in the future, I will have to set bottom lines. I will have to tell him that a help once in a while is ok, but not regularly. I guess I have been too kind to him. If it was anyone else who lived with him, he would have annoyed his flatmate very much.

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#24 Speaking Interview Read

1:26

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Talk about a special toy you had as a child.

- What was it?
- What did it look like?
- Do you still have it?

Record

Re-practice Submit

Answer

I have a special toy that is a teddy bear, which is a 6-year-old birthday gift from my mother, and it is my first stuffed toy that I cherish very much. The teddy bear is in the form of a bear, and it is a stuffed toy that is very fluffy when I touch it, which makes me feel very comfortable when I hold it in my arms. The teddy bear has the color of brown, and it is wearing white pajamas. It looks cute that I can't help but hold it in my arms every night when I sleep. I still have this teddy bear now, and it is sitting beside my pillow every day, when I hold it in my arms, it still can remind me of my happy childhood and the comfort it gives me.

20:57 15-03-2021

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hedwigu.com/practice/Speakinglr/?num=25

1:25

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Talk about your favorite season of the year.

- What is the weather like?
- What things do you like to do in this season?
- Why do you like it more than the others?

Record

Re-practice Submit

Answer

There are four seasons in a year: winter, spring, summer, and autumn. All seasons are good in their own way. Winter, for example, is full of celebrations, presents, and snow. Spring is the time of nature awakening and flower blooming. Autumn can be rainy and yet beautiful, full of multi-colored leaves. However, my favorite season is summer. I choose summer not only because my birthday is in May, but also because it's the time of holidays. Summer is the season when the sun shines brightly, the sky is rarely cloudy, and the water in the sea becomes warm enough to swim. Even if it becomes too hot, you can always go for a walk in the shady woods. I also like summer because there are many berries, fruits, and vegetables, not to mention numerous flowers in the fields. Sometimes the air in summer becomes stuffy, but occasional thunderstorms bring relief. After the thunderstorms, the air becomes remarkably fresh, and very often, we can see the rainbow in the sky. Summer is also the time when my family and I go on holiday to the seaside. It's a wonderful time when we can have a rest from the intense academic year and relax. I think all children love summer because of long school holidays and I'm no exception. I also enjoy my free time, playing with my friends, watching TV, and doing other fun activities. It is a great time that we can enjoy ourselves.

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20:57 15-03-2021

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1:28

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Talk about telling a lie.

- Is it always wrong to tell a lie?
- Why or why not?
- Would you lie in order to save someone's life?

Record

Re-practice Submit

Answer

At a young age, many of us are taught that telling a lie is absolutely wrong. Yet as we grow up, we slowly become exposed to small "white" lies — those told to keep us from becoming upset or sad. Even as we transition into adulthood, well-meaning lies are often told to shield a person from criticism or added hardship. So it is not always wrong to tell a lie. There are times when a white lie seems to be the least offensive thing to say. For example, someone gives you a gift you don't like. Do you say you don't like it or something such as: "Thanks for the thoughtful gift?" However, if every lie told could prevent harm to another person, without any ill-effects, or even can save someone's life, it would make the answer to this question more clear that a lie is definitely worth it.

20:57 15-03-2021

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20:58 15-03-2021

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#27 Speaking Interview Read

1:22

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Describe how people can supplement their income.

- Why might a person need to supplement their income?
- What are some ways that people supplement their income?
- Is it common for people to supplement their main income?

Re-practice Submit

Answer

When it comes to the reasons why people need to supplement their income, I suppose one of the most important one is that they need the extra amount of money to financially support their living, and probably their families' living as well. Because money is the universal currency to buy anything you need and want. However, not all people are skilled and knowledgeable enough to secure a full-time job that offers a decent amount of salary. Therefore, they need to look for ways to supplement their income. And most people get extra income usually by working multiple shifts a day and committing to several jobs throughout the week, and some are probably working 7 days a week. I reckon it is rather commonplace for people to supplement their income, particularly those who live in underdeveloped countries, such as north-east Asian countries and African countries, where citizens' living standard is relatively low compared to those living in developed countries. And such phenomenon is inversely proportional to the maturity of the economic system in a country.

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20:58 15-03-2021

#28 Speaking Interview Read

1:24

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Discuss how people commute to work.

- How do people commute to work?
- How long do people spend commuting?
- How will commuting change in the future?

Record

Re-practice

Submit

Answer

Nowadays, most people commute by public traffic, such as buses and subway. Employees travel longer and longer to get to their workplace, and they have to cover long distances. The national average commute time in China is over 30 minutes. That means as a whole, the daily average Chinese commute time is about an hour, assuming one round trip. The longer your commute, the less time you have for family, friends, exercise, and nutrition—and it's awful for your mental state. A recent study found that people with long commutes are 33 percent more likely to suffer from depression, 12 percent more likely to report work-related stress, and 46 percent get less than seven hours of sleep each night. In the future, commuting methods and the commute itself will begin to shift as transportation alternatives evolve, and the increasing prevalence of flexible work continues to provide alternatives. The commute itself will become more flexible and personalized, faster, more environmentally-friendly, and less dependent on single-occupant cars.

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#29 Speaking Interview Read

1:26

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Describe someone in your country who is currently in the spotlight.

- Why are they in the spotlight?
- Is this an important person?
- What do you imagine their future will be like?

Record

Record

Re-practice Submit

Answer

TFboys, also known as The Fighting Boys, is the most popular Chinese idol group nowadays. It consists of three members: Karry Wang, Roy Wang, and Jackson Yee. The group debuted on August 6, 2013 with their first single album "Start of Love" at the young ages of 12 and 13 years old. Within a year of their debut, TFboys became one of the most popular artists in China with their hit song "Manual of Youth" and gained widespread popularity throughout Asia. They are often cited as one of the most influential acts to shape the Mando-pop industry in recent years by helping to spread Chinese culture internationally. They are dubbed as one of the most successful Chinese boy bands to hit mainstream media in sales, influence, and endorsement value. The band is seen as a spiritual successor of former Chinese band Xiao Hu Dui by the media due to high similarities between them. I think in the near future, they will gain more popularity worldwide.

Record

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#30 Speaking Interview Read

1:25

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Talk about a decision that you regret.

- What was your decision?
- What do you wish you had done differently?

Record

Re-practice Submit

Answer

When it comes to the decision that I regret, the first thing that jumps into my mind is the decision that I made when selecting universities. I had chosen a university far away from my hometown, which made it difficult for me to spend any time with my parents. Especially the older they are getting, the more regret I become. If I could go back to the time when choosing a university, I will choose the one near my hometown. A close family ensures everyone feels loved, supported, and strong. So, whatever life throws at your way, you'll always be able to overcome it with the strength of the family unit. As one of the famous experts says, "At the end of your life, you will never regret not having passed one more test, not winning one more verdict, or not closing one more deal. You will regret time not spent with a husband, a friend, a child, a parent."

20:59 15-03-2021

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Talk about a wealthy country.

- Why is the country wealthy?
- How does wealth affect the citizens?
- What responsibilities does a wealthy country have in the world?



Re-practice

Submit

Answer

The United States is one of the wealthiest countries in the world, with a GNI per capita of \$54,000. The U.S. is much more of a consumer of goods and services than a producer. Goods and services exports accounted for just 12% of U.S. GDP in 2016, by far the lowest share of any country on this list. Despite being one of the wealthiest nations, the United States has a relatively low life expectancy of the citizens compared to other rich countries. This may be because it is the only developed nation without universal health care. Another potential cause may be the country's large gap between the rich and the poor – one of the world's largest – meaning that impoverished citizens may be unable to obtain necessary medical and preventive care. It is the wealthy countries' responsibilities to stop the carbon emission. Even as some of the wealthiest countries change their own energy policies, the world's wealthier nations must also help developing countries create sustainable energy grids. Wealthy countries must offer aid and policies to reverse deforestation in the Amazon, Indonesia and other vital forests to remove carbon from the atmosphere

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Describe a factory or office you have visited.

- What type of work did they do there?
- What did the space look like?
- Why did you visit it?



Re-practice

Submit

Answer

A few months back I went to a call centre office named 'Tech 5' where my friend Ronald used to work. It was a huge office with more than 300 employees and was on the entire 3rd floor of the Lotus building. This company is the largest call centre in our city and has employed many professionals and students. This company mainly relied on outsourcing and call centre jobs. The agents in this office were mostly young people who either called the end users for selling products or services or received calls to give certain information to customers or to record their complaints about a particular product or service. The office used to work for large multinational companies to provide the customer care service or to promote their products or services. In return, they would earn the commissions or a contracted amount. They also had a software development and web designing team who used to work for the direct clients. I went to meet my friend Ronald who was in office at that time. He asked me to lend him some story books and was supposed to meet me near my home. But in the evening he called me to meet him in his office so that I could give him the books as well as talk to his manager regarding a part time job I was looking for.

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Talk about why children tease other children.

- What things do children tease each other about?
- What are the effects of teasing?
- Were you ever teased as a child?



Re-practice

Submit

Answer

In my opinion, children tease for a number of different reasons, and teasing brings various effects. First and foremost, children tease for attention because it is a good way of receiving negative attention. For many children, negative attention is better than no attention. Secondly, children tease for feelings of power or superiority. Many teasers feel superior when they put others down, or they may feel powerful when teasing upsets others. Thirdly, some children model or mimic what is happening to them at home by acting the same way to others at school or in the neighbourhood. These teasers are children who may be teased by siblings or who experience aggressive or harsh parenting. Teasing can be used to make jokes, it can be used to play tricks, or it can be used to hurt someone as offense or defence. When children do it to each other, teasing can lead to bullying. In fact, teasing really steps away from bullying, if the behavior continues and if it is becoming hurtful. When I was in grade 6, I was teased by 3 children who were bigger than me, and I got robbed of 5 Chinese yuan.

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Talk about one type of severe weather.

- What problems do people worry about?
- What should people do to protect themselves from this type of weather?



Re-practice

Submit

Answer

A thunderstorm is a storm with lightning and thunder. It's produced by a cumulonimbus cloud, usually producing strong winds, heavy rain and sometimes hail. All thunderstorms are dangerous. Every thunderstorm produces lightning, which kills more people each year than tornadoes. They can also lead to floods which may, in turn, cause power outages and other serious issues. IF there is a thunderstorm, and you are outdoors, keep an eye at the sky. Look for darkening skies, flashes of lightning, or increasing winds. Lightning often proceeds rain, so don't wait for the rain to begin. If you hear the sound of thunder, go to a safe place immediately. The best place to go is a sturdy building or a car, but make sure the windows in the car are shut. Avoid sheds, picnic areas, baseball dugouts and bleachers. If there is no shelter around you, stay away from trees. And if you are indoors, avoid water. It's a great conductor of electricity, so do not take a shower, wash your hands, wash dishes or do laundry. Do not use a corded telephone. Lightning may strike exterior phone lines. Do not use electric equipment like computers and appliances during a storm. Stay away from windows and doors and stay off porches.

1:28

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Describe someone who is well-organized.

- Who is this person?
- How do they stay organized?
- Are you well-organized?

[Re-practice](#)[Submit](#)

Answer

My friend William is an organized person, he always keeps his desk clean, and his house is tidy and neat. He is punctual, finishes projects with time to spare, and always knows exactly where to find what he needs when he needs it. He uses a variety of tools and methods to accomplish his goals and priorities in life. Instead of having an overwhelming number of commitments and little idea where to start, he has a clear sense of what's important. He keeps track of what he needs to accomplish and when. For instance, he uses mobile phone apps with pop-up reminders. I have learnt quite a lot from William in terms of how to stay organized, and now I am also well-organized.

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Talk about the last time you went shopping.

- What did you buy?
- Where did you go?
- Did anyone go with you?



Re-practice

Submit

Answer

The last time I went shopping for clothes, I took my best friend Mary with me to Westfield. I hate shopping with my mother because I tend to browse a number of stores before making my final decision, but she isn't very patient. On the other hand, Mary always tells me when she thinks a colour doesn't suit me. But my mother is like "Okay, okay, it's perfect, you don't need to try another, come on, come on, let's go" which is kind of annoying. I bought a plain white cotton shirt, a yellow top and a light blue coat. I love my new coat. Generally, I go shopping once or twice a month. Depending on the day, I like to shop at shopping centers or in local shops. And I usually go shopping when there are discounts, bargains or sales. I haven't got a lot of money and I am also saving money to pay my fees at university.

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Related Links

Aviation Education Center

1:27

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Talk about something that upset you.

- What happened?
- What did you do about it?

[Re-practice](#)[Submit](#)

Answer

When I find out that a friend was lying to me, it's a hard fact to accept. The real challenge lies in how I respond once I catch someone in the act. The moment when I learnt that my best friend Jack lied to me about the fact that he was going abroad to further his study, he was already on the plane to America. We promised to go to the same university and company each other forever. I read the text message his mother sent to me again and again, and I couldn't believe that was happening. Till the very last minute, he didn't dare to tell me the truth himself. I was overwhelmed with sadness and happiness at the same time. I was upset obviously because my bestie was going to leave me. I was definitely going to miss him very much. Without Jack, there would be no one to hang out with. I was glad because he was going to pursue a brighter prospect. That lie broke our relationship. We never contacted since then. I learnt that friends should always be honest to each other since a healthy relationship hinges on trust, and a lie can easily destroy that bond.

1:28

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Talk about the job of a salesperson.

- Where does a salesperson work?
- Is it a difficult job?
- Would you like to be a salesperson?



Re-practice

Submit

Answer

The salesperson is a type of job selling products not only to customers but also to businesses and organizations on behalf of the manufacturers. Most of the salespeople we meet in our daily life are those who are standing behind the counter in the department stores. They ask for customer's need, recommend the appropriate products to them, show them how to use it, and finally check out. To be a qualified salesperson, it is necessary to know the details and characteristics of the products they are going to sell. It is a difficult job also because salesperson needs to catch customer's interest with only a few sentences and can lead them to purchase, therefore; mastering needs of the targeted customer is essential. From my personal perspective, if there is any chance, I would like to try being a salesperson in fashion field. It is an opportunity for me to practice my communication skills in the real business world.

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Talk about an article you recently read in a newspaper, magazine, or online.

- When you read it?
- What was it about?
- Was it a good or bad news and why?



Re-practice

Submit

Answer

When it comes to the article I lately read, I would like to talk about one online article. I read this article when I was searching material for my assignments two weeks ago. It is an inspiring article that discusses about the global warming and the environment changes, and more importantly, how the humankind has contributed to this damage and finally, how to take further actions to protect our environment. Although it is not a new topic, that article highlights how significantly individual's actions affect the global environment, which leads me to think what I can do in my daily life for the sake of environment. It is hard to decide whether it is a good or bad news. The phenomenon mentioned in the articles includes the degradation, deforestation, and air pollution, which seems like bad news. However, at the end part of the articles, it also presents the hope to the readers that many organizations are working together to solve the problems.

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Describe something you have done that you would not normally do.

- Why did you do it?
- How did it affect you?
- If you could go back in time, would you do it again?
- Why or why not?



Re-practice

Submit

Answer

Speaking of something I have done that I would not normally do, it must be the roller coaster ride on my 18-year-old birthday. I invited my close friends to play in a newly opened park. At the end of our play, my friends asked me to take the roller coaster with them, saying I have to challenge myself to celebrate that memorable day. I have hesitated for a while and finally summoned up the courage to ride with them. And I even found I did enjoy the speed and excitement. If I could go back to that time, I would still make the same decision. After that ride, I realized that some challenges are not as horrible as I thought, I cannot always avoid doing them. Instead of telling myself I cannot do it, why would not try to do it first? With more courage, I can conquer the fear and they will bring unexpected surprises to me.

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Talk about something you are especially competent at.

- How did you become competent at this?
- Do you know other people who are competent at this also?
- If I wanted to learn this skill, what would you advise me to do?



Re-practice

Submit

Answer

In terms of something I am especially competent at, it must be table tennis, the sport I learnt when I was 7-year-old. In primary school, we had the opportunity to pick up one sport as extra-curriculum activities. Influenced by my father, who is an amateur player, I chose table tennis and practiced playing it at least twice a week. After primary school, I still keep playing table tennis with my families and friends on weekends. One of my friends even became a professional player and won the medal in the national games. Since table tennis is one of the most popular sports in China, the table can be easily found in parks and community clubs. To learn how to play table tennis, I highly suggest you learn from the basic skills first, such as bump the ball, because it can help you to build up advanced skills on a solid foundation.

1:27

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Talk about the increase in worldwide travel.

- How is it beneficial for people?
- What are some negative effects?
- What has caused this increase?



Re-practice

Submit

Answer

As travelling by airplanes becoming common, worldwide travel has increased significantly. Without doubts, people can broaden their horizon by travelling abroad since they will have the opportunity to experience exotic cultures themselves. For some people who are working on creative jobs, travelling can bring diverse ideas to them. There is a quote, which goes 'The world is a book, and those who do not travel read only one page'. Travelling can also help us to establish connections and build networks abroad, which is beneficial to our further developments. However, there are also negative effects brought on by increasing travel. Especially in developing countries, people there have less capacity to solve the pollution and garbage left in attractions. One of the main reasons for the increase is that the prices of air tickets become acceptable to common people. Moreover, influenced by online media, people are more willing to step out of their home to see what it looks like in other parts of the world.

1:28

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Describe a skill you want to learn.

- Why do you think it is important?
- How are you going to learn it?

[Re-practice](#)[Submit](#)

Answer

Among all the skills, the skill that I want to learn the most is swimming since it is a necessary skill in daily life. After moving to a coastal city, I find many local residents enjoy swimming in the sea. And I can teach my children how to swim and play with them in the future if I can obtain this skill myself. In order to learn swimming, the first step is to conquer my fear of water. Then, I am going to enrol in a swimming class so that I can establish a foundation for swimming. If I can master the most basic swimming stroke, breaststroke, I would like to challenge the freestyle and backstroke. From my friend's experience, keep swimming as a habit can also benefit the entire body by increasing heart rate without stressing muscles. Learning a new skill is always interesting as it indicates a new adventure.

1:28

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Tell me about a part of your city that is changing.

- Where is it?
- How is it changing?
- Why do you think it is changing?



Re-practice

Submit

Answer

The city I live in is Sydney which is one of the capital cities in Australia. It accommodates more than 200 million people. And it is now changing in a lot of aspects among which the most noticeable are public facilities that people live in the city are using on a frequent basis. For instance, the state government and local council are putting a joint effort into improving the current public transportation system. A large number of new trains have been put into use on the most popular lines in an attempt to increase the capacity to mitigate the rush hour congestion. Meanwhile, they are working tirelessly to roll out more light rails and trams. The major reason for implementing this change is that there have been numerous complaints about public transport over the past decade. And the government has realized that they have to do something to make this city more liveable and more agreeable.

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Describe how people lived 100 years ago.

- How were their lives different from people's lives now?
- What kinds of difficulties did people have?
- Would you like to have lived during that time?



Re-practice

Submit

Answer

As far as I am concerned, one of the major differences between the lives people lived 100 years ago and now is the way in which people communicate. At that time, people did not have mobile phones, and thus they could only make calls via telephones or send handwritten letters. Both of the means were rather inefficient, especially with the letters because it would probably take several days, or even longer if the letter was to be delivered overseas before it could reach to the recipient. The messages contained in the letter would probably have already been out of date by then. However, now with the invention of mobile phones and the Internet, people are able to communicate with others instantly by sending emails online or making phone calls wherever they are. In cases where visual contact is required, people can even conveniently make video-calls, which was undreamt of 100 years ago. For this reason alone, I would not like to have lived during that time.

1:28

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Describe a typical day for you, when you are not working or studying.

- What do you do?
- Do you enjoy your days off?
- How is this different from other days?



Re-practice

Submit

Answer

I am a university student. When I do not have classes, I try to spend my time with ease and relaxation so that I can get refreshed and recharged. On one such day, I get up late from sleep and cook myself a decent brunch which is usually made up of scrambled eggs, fresh tomatoes, slices of bacon and toasts. I then go to the supermarket to purchase some necessities that I am short of at home. After I get home, I do my laundry and clean up my room. Then I watch movies or TV serials till 5 and cook dinner with the fresh ingredients I just bought. Sometimes, I hang around with my friends. Hanging with friends, watching movies, listening to music, cleaning and cooking are the main enjoyment I have during my typical free days. Such a day is quite different from my other typical days as I do not need to get up early, go to university, attend lectures or write assignments. Such days are critically important for me because I can get relieved from the monotonous routines and scheduled life.

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Describe the urgent needs of a population following a natural disaster.

- What is the most critical need?
- How should governments prepare for natural disasters?
- How can private citizens help disaster victims?



Re-practice

Submit

Answer

When it comes to the urgent needs of a population following a natural disaster, the first thing that jumps into my mind is the provision of necessities of life. That includes an uninterrupted supply of water and electricity and the distribution of food and clothes to keep warmth. Those necessities of life are of critical need because a natural disaster can usually destroy a broad range of properties and infrastructures, such as people's houses and power plants, and hence leave people with no places to live in and water and electricity to use. In terms of the preparation for natural disasters, there are a lot that governments can do before their occurrence. For example, emergency power supply should be built in every city, especially for critical places like hospitals; stock of food, drinking water and blankets should always be readily accessible; and communicate service companies should make contingency plans against natural disasters to keep communication service functioning even after the strike. Private citizens can also help disaster victims by donating money and material resources to facilitate the post-disaster recovery.

1:28

Prepare to speak for at least 30 seconds about the question below

Discuss the future of food.

- What is the likelihood of food shortages in the future?
- How will people's food choices change?
- Where will people get food in the future?



Record

Re-practice

Submit

Answer

The world currently produces more than enough food to feed everyone, yet there are still millions of people suffering from hunger. The global population is expected to exceed 10 billion within the current century. Plus climate change, urbanization, and soil degradation will shrink the availability of arable land. Together they will lead to far greater stress on food supplies. What's worse, global water shortage and pollution can have a devastating effect on crops. Therefore, the likelihood of food shortages in the future is rather high. If food shortages occur in the future, I suppose people's food choice would greatly alter. One of the most likely switches would be to preserved food, such as canned spam and vegetables, because it can be easily stored and last much longer than those freshly harvested. People will get supplementary food sources from synthetic food made by using nanotechnology.